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CHAPTER 1

ARRIVAL OF EUROPEANS IN INDIA (PART 1)

Portuguese in India

Introduction

Before the 15th century, European countries wanted to trade with India because Indian spices, silk, cotton, and other goods were in great demand. The land route to India was difficult and expensive. Therefore, European countries started searching for a **sea route to India**. The Portuguese were the first Europeans to discover this route, which marked the beginning of European rule in India.

Why did the Portuguese come to India?

- They wanted a **direct sea route** to India.
- They wanted to buy **spices** directly from India.
- They wanted to earn more profit by avoiding Arab traders.
- **Prince Henry of Portugal**, known as "**The Navigator**", encouraged sea voyages and navigation.

Exam Fact: Prince Henry is known as "**The Navigator**."

Vasco da Gama

Vasco da Gama was a Portuguese sailor who became the **first European to reach India by sea**.

Important Facts

- Reached **Calicut (Kerala)** in **May 1498**.
- Guided by a Gujarati pilot named **Abdul Majid**.
- Welcomed by the local ruler **Zamorin**.
- His arrival opened the sea route between **Europe and India**.

Remember

- First European by sea → **Vasco da Gama**
- Landing place → **Calicut**
- Local ruler → **Zamorin**
- Pilot → **Abdul Majid**

Pedro Álvares Cabral

After Vasco da Gama's success, Portugal sent another expedition to India.

Important Facts

- Arrived in **1500**.
- Second Portuguese expedition to India.
- Established a **Portuguese trading factory at Calicut**.

Vasco da Gama's Second Visit

Portugal wanted to strengthen its trade in India.

Important Facts

- Vasco da Gama returned to India in **1502**.
- Portuguese trading centres were developed at:
 - **Calicut**
 - **Cochin**
 - **Cannanore**

Francisco de Almeida

Portugal appointed governors to protect its trade and increase its power in India.

Important Facts

- **First Portuguese Governor (Viceroy) in India**
- Appointed in **1505**.
- Introduced the **Blue Water Policy (Cartaz System)**.

What was the Blue Water Policy?

The main aim was to **control sea trade** and make the Portuguese the strongest naval power in the Indian Ocean.

Exam Fact

Blue Water Policy → Francisco de Almeida

Battle of Diu (1509)

The Portuguese had to fight other powers to control sea trade.

Important Facts

- Fought in **1509**.
- Portuguese defeated the combined forces of:
 - Gujarat
 - Egypt (Mamluks)
 - Zamorin of Calicut
- This victory made Portugal the strongest naval power in the Indian Ocean.

Alfonso de Albuquerque

Albuquerque was the most successful Portuguese Governor in India.

Important Facts

- Known as the **Founder of Portuguese Power in India**.
- Captured **Goa** from the **Sultan of Bijapur** in **1510**.
- Introduced the **Policy of Imperialism**.
- Encouraged permanent Portuguese settlements in India.
- Portuguese introduced **tobacco** and **cashew** during their rule.

Exam Fact: Goa became the main centre of Portuguese power in India.

Nuno da Cunha

Nuno da Cunha further strengthened Portuguese administration.

Important Facts

- Became Governor in **1529**.
- Shifted the Portuguese headquarters from **Cochin to Goa**.
- **Goa became the capital in 1530**.

Portuguese Expansion in India

Within a few decades, the Portuguese controlled many important coastal areas.

Important Portuguese Centres

- Goa
- Cochin
- Calicut
- Cannanore
- Daman
- Diu
- San Thome (Chennai)
- Nagapattinam (Tamil Nadu)

Decline of the Portuguese

The Portuguese gradually lost their power because stronger European countries entered India.

Important Facts

- **1608:** Captain **William Hawkins** reached **Surat** and met **Emperor Jahangir**.
- Hawkins knew the **Turkish (Turki)** language and became a **Mansabdar of 400**.
- During **Shah Jahan's** reign, Portuguese influence in the Mughal court declined.
- **1612:** Portuguese lost control over Surat to the English.
- **1663:** Dutch captured most Portuguese forts on the Malabar Coast.
- **1961:** India liberated **Goa, Daman, and Diu**, ending Portuguese rule.

Exam Fact: Portuguese were the **first Europeans to come to India** and the **last Europeans to leave India**.

Important Personalities

Personality	Contribution
Prince Henry	Encouraged sea exploration; called " The Navigator "
Vasco da Gama	First European to reach India by sea
Abdul Majid	Gujarati pilot who guided Vasco da Gama
Zamorin	Hindu ruler of Calicut
Pedro Álvares Cabral	Established Portuguese factory at Calicut
Francisco de Almeida	First Portuguese Governor; Blue Water Policy
Alfonso de Albuquerque	Founder of Portuguese Power in India
Nuno da Cunha	Shifted headquarters to Goa
William Hawkins	First English representative at Jahangir's court
Jahangir	Gave trading privileges to the English

Important Places

Place	Importance
Calicut (Kerala)	Vasco da Gama landed here in 1498
Cochin (Kerala)	First Portuguese fort (1503)
Cannanore (Kerala)	Second Portuguese fort (1505)
Goa	Captured in 1510; Portuguese capital from 1530
Diu	Battle of Diu (1509)
Surat (Gujarat)	William Hawkins arrived here in 1608

Important Battles / Policies

Name	Year	Importance
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Blue Water Policy	1500	Introduced by Francisco de Almeida to control sea trade
Battle of Diu	1509	Established Portuguese naval supremacy
Policy of Imperialism	1510	Introduced by Albuquerque

Important Years

Year	Event
1498	Vasco da Gama reached Calicut
1500	Pedro Álvares Cabral arrived in India
1502	Vasco da Gama's second visit
1503	First Portuguese fort at Cochin
1505	Francisco de Almeida became Governor; Fort at Cannanore
1509	Battle of Diu
1510	Goa captured by Albuquerque
1529	Nuno da Cunha became Governor
1530	Goa became Portuguese capital
1559	Portuguese captured Daman
1608	William Hawkins reached Surat
1612	Portuguese lost Surat
1663	Dutch captured Portuguese forts on Malabar Coast
1961	Goa, Daman and Diu liberated by India

Frequently Confused Facts

Question	Correct Answer
First European to reach India by sea	Vasco da Gama
First Portuguese Governor	Francisco de Almeida
Founder of Portuguese Power in India	Alfonso de Albuquerque
Blue Water Policy	Francisco de Almeida
Policy of Imperialism	Alfonso de Albuquerque
First Portuguese fort	Cochin
Portuguese capital	Goa
First Europeans to arrive	Portuguese

Previous Year Exam Focus

- Vasco da Gama's arrival (1498)
- Calicut and Zamorin
- Blue Water Policy
- Francisco de Almeida
- Alfonso de Albuquerque
- Goa
- Battle of Diu
- Tobacco and Cashew
- Portuguese capital
- First and last European facts

Expected MCQ Areas

- Portuguese Governors
- Blue Water Policy
- Goa and Cochin
- Important years
- Vasco da Gama
- Battle of Diu
- Portuguese settlements
- Portuguese decline

Quick Revision

- Prince Henry → **The Navigator**
- Vasco da Gama → **1498** → **Calicut**
- Abdul Majid → **Gujarati Pilot**
- Zamorin → **Ruler of Calicut**
- Pedro Cabral → **1500**
- Almeida → **First Governor**
- Blue Water Policy → **Almeida**
- Battle of Diu → **1509**
- Albuquerque → **Founder of Portuguese Power**
- Goa → **1510**

- Imperialism → **Albuquerque**
- Tobacco → **Portuguese**
- Cashew → **Portuguese**
- Nuno da Cunha → **1529**
- Goa Capital → **1530**
- William Hawkins → **1608**
- Jahangir → **Hawkins**
- Portuguese left India → **1961**
- First Europeans → **Portuguese**
- Last Europeans to leave → **Portuguese**

Memory Tricks

- **A for Almeida → A for Aqua (Blue Water Policy).**
- **A for Albuquerque → A for Acquired Goa.**
- **1498 → Vasco da Gama opened the sea route to India.**
- **First Governor = Almeida | Founder = Albuquerque (Most Frequently Asked Difference)**
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